

Social media fading away?

According to a survey on 2,000 youngsters in India's metros, users are spending lesser and lesser time on social networks <http://bit.ly/xN05ZV>

Apple iBooks 2

Following Steve Jobs' vision of reinventing education, Apple has launched the iBooks 2 app, iBooks Author tool, and iTunes U <http://bit.ly/ytG7mA>

Don't be evil, just vandalise

Google has been accused of vandalising maps of the OpenStreetMap project, a crowd-sourced project run by a UK-based non-profit firm. Malicious edits were made to a few of the wiki-style maps, and while these are definitely not irregular occurrences for an open project, the editing users were traced to an IP address range belonging to Google India.

Three senior members of Google Maps' rival, OpenStreetMap (OSM) project, announced the incident on



a company blog post, titled "Google IP Vandalizing OpenStreetMap".

OSM alleged that Google's presence on its web site by these particular users was quite strong in January and it could possibly take them some time before a full analysis is done. In fact over the past year, it has had over 102,000 hits on OSM thanks to at least 17 accounts from this Google IP.

Responding to the allegations, a Google spokesperson said that it had identified the two people behind the OSM accounts, and claimed that they were just contractors using machines on Google's network. The contractors were apparently "acting on their own behalf" and are "no longer working on Google projects."

After a similar Mocality incident earlier this month

from the same IP address range, it certainly is surprising that Google didn't tighten up practices. So far, the majority of the web pundits believe that Google wouldn't be so reckless to blatantly tamper with its Google Maps competitor. OSM founder chairman, Steve Coast, admitted to finding the Google link to

its tampered maps perplexing.

"These actions are somewhat baffling given our past good relationship with Google which has included donations and Summer of Code work. As a community we take the quality of our data extremely seriously and look forward to an explanation from Google and an undertaking to not allow this kind of thing to happen in the future.", said an OSM representative. ■

MegaUpload shutdown, Anonymous retaliates

The U.S. Department of Justice (DOJ) announced that it shut down Megaupload, the one-click hosting online service and charged its members on five counts of copyright infringement and conspiracy by trafficking and hosting pirated image and video content. Four out of seven of the site's owners and operators have been arrested.

Meanwhile, hacktivist group, Anonymous retaliated to the Megaupload closure by shutting down the web site of the DOJ, Universal Music Group, MPAA, RIAA and U.S. Copyright office on 19th January. The group called it the single biggest strike in its history. ■

Even passwords won't help you

Wi-Fi users in the country are vulnerable to virus attacks, warns Indian Computer Emergency Response Team (CERT-In). The firm has discovered that the Wi-Fi Protected Setup (WPS) has a design error, increasing risks of virus attacks that potentially allow attackers to take control of even a password protected system.

The CERT-In alert to consumers read: "The virus is streaming in the Indian Internet networks with a high severity. The combat mechanisms are



being deployed. An unauthenticated, remote attacker within range of the wireless access point could use the PIN (password) to gain unauthorised access to the device to retrieve the password for the wireless network or change the configuration of the device. Failed

attempts to exploit the vulnerability could lead to a denial of service condition."

The agency also pointed out its reports that revealed several WPS devices do not feature any kind of lockout policy for such attack attempts. Users in India mostly use the WPS method to set up a wireless router for home network. The WPS procedure requires a PIN to be used during setup. The CERT-In alert elaborated that users should disable the external registrar feature of the WPS to protect their devices from virus attacks. ■